

DIGITALAIKART

PREMIUM DIGITAL PRODUCTS

THE INSTAGRAM BRAND DEAL KIT

The Indian Creator Edition

12 copy-paste pitch scripts, the 2026 India rate card,
the media kit formula, and the payment-protection
rules that get creators paid on time.

12

COPY-PASTE
PITCH SCRIPTS

4

RATE
TABLES

14

SHORT, FOCUSED
CHAPTERS

30

DAY FIRST-DEAL
ACTION PLAN

Built for Indian creators. Verified for 2026. Ready to use today.

First Edition | Verified September 2026 | digitalkartai.shop

CHAPTER 1

How this kit works

If you are an Indian creator who wants brands to pay you - reliably, at fair rates, without getting stiffed on payment - this kit is your complete system. It is built from what actually works in the Indian market in 2026, not recycled US advice.

Everything here is copy-paste or fill-in. You do not need to read cover to cover before starting. The fastest path for most creators:

- 1 Open Chapter 3, find your follower tier in the rate tables, and write down your numbers (30 minutes).
- 2 Build your one-page rate card from the worksheet in Chapter 4 (30 minutes).
- 3 Pick the script that fits your situation in Chapter 7, personalise the brackets, and send your first three pitches today (30 minutes).
- 4 Before you agree to any deal, run it through the payment checklist in Chapter 10 and the ASCI rules in Chapter 11.

The rest of the chapters fill in the machine around those moves: finding the right brands, negotiating without losing the deal, protecting usage rights, and staying on the right side of India's disclosure rules.

What you will have by the end of 30 days

A finished rate card, a media kit, a list of 30 target brands, 12 scripts you can reuse forever, and a weekly pitching rhythm - the complete pipeline most creators never build. Follow the plan in Chapter 13 and your first paid deal typically lands within 2-4 weeks of consistent outreach.

A note on the numbers: every rate, rule and platform fact in this kit was verified against current Indian market sources and ASCI's official guidelines as of September 2026. Rates are honest market bands, not fantasy figures - use them as your floor, not your ceiling.

CHAPTER 2

The 2026 brand deal landscape

Brand deals are the highest-paid income stream for Indian creators on Instagram, and the market has moved decisively toward smaller creators. Roughly 70 percent of brands now prefer nano and micro creators under 100K followers because engagement and audience trust beat raw reach. You do not need a million followers. You need a niche, proof of work, and a professional pitch.

There are three kinds of deals on the table, and they pay for different things:

Deal type	What you deliver	What the brand pays for	Typical India rate
UGC creation	Video or photo files the brand uses in its own ads and social	Content creation + usage rights	Rs. 800-8,000 per asset
Influencer post	Reel or post to your own audience with a brand mention	Access to your audience + your credibility	Rs. 2,000-50,000+ per post by reach
Barter / gifting	Post mentioning the brand in exchange for free product	Nothing - it is unpaid	Zero cash

The single most important fact in this chapter: **UGC deals need zero followers**. Brands buying UGC care about the quality of the video file, not your audience. A 600-follower creator with three strong portfolio videos can command the same UGC rate as a 60,000-follower creator. If you are starting from zero, UGC is your entry door; influencer posts (usually 5,000+ followers, often 10,000+) come next as your audience grows.

Barter is not evil, but it is not income. Accept it only when you are under 10K followers and building a portfolio, you genuinely want the product, or the product is high-value (Rs. 5,000+). Past your first few deals, a barter-only brand is telling you it has budget - it just hopes you will not ask for it. Script 10 in Chapter 7 is the reply for that conversation.

Your engagement rate is your pricing power

Engagement rate = (likes + comments + saves + shares) divided by followers, times 100. Check it in Instagram Insights on any recent post. Indian market benchmarks: below 3% is low and brands will push your rate down; 3-5% is strong; 5%+ is excellent; 6%+ lets you pitch at a premium. Micro creators with 6% engagement routinely out-earn mid-tier creators with 2%.

CHAPTER 3

What you should charge: the 2026 rate card

Indian creators undercharge by 30-50 percent on average, mostly because they have no idea what the market pays. These four tables fix that. All figures are Indian market bands for Instagram collabs as of September 2026.

Table 1 - Sponsored post benchmarks by follower tier

Creator tier	Followers	Sponsored post starting benchmark
Nano	1K-10K	Rs. 1,000-5,000+
Micro	10K-100K	Rs. 5,000-25,000+
Mid-tier	100K-500K	Rs. 25,000-1,50,000+
Macro	500K-1M	Rs. 1,50,000-5,00,000+
Mega	1M+	Custom pricing

Table 2 - Rates by format (the starter card most brands expect)

Followers	Story set	Reel (on your account)	UGC video (brand-owned)
1K-10K	Rs. 500-2,000	Rs. 1,500-8,000	Rs. 2,000-8,000
10K-50K	Rs. 2,000-6,000	Rs. 8,000-25,000	Rs. 4,000-12,000
50K-100K	Rs. 6,000-12,000	Rs. 25,000-40,000	Rs. 8,000-15,000

As a rule of thumb: Stories (which vanish in 24 hours and reach only existing followers) go for roughly 30-50 percent of your Reel rate, while a UGC video the brand uses in paid ads sells at a premium to a simple organic Reel.

Table 3 - The base formula and adjustments

If you remember one pricing rule, remember this: **Rs. 1,000 per 10,000 followers per Instagram Reel** is the widely used Indian starting floor - a 50K-follower creator starts at roughly Rs. 5,000. It is a floor, not a target. Move up from it like this:

- **Engagement above 3-5%** - push toward the top of your band; above 6% quote above it.
- **Niche multiplier** - finance and investing 1.5-2x; tech 1.3-1.5x; parenting 1.2-1.5x; fitness 1.0-1.3x; travel 1.0-1.2x; beauty and fashion 1.0x (the baseline); food 0.8-1.0x; lifestyle 0.8-1.0x; entertainment 0.7-0.9x.
- **Paid ad usage rights** - add 30-100 percent. If your face runs in the brand's ads, you are selling a licence, not a post (Chapter 9).
- **Rush delivery** - 48-hour turnarounds justify a 25-50 percent bump.
- **Exclusivity** - if you cannot work with a competitor for 60-90 days, that is paid too.

Table 4 - Packages and retainers

- **Bundles:** a typical campaign package (1 Reel + 3 Stories + 1 feed post) prices at 1.5-1.8x your Reel rate - less than the sum of parts, but more per campaign than a single post.
- **Retainers:** after 2-3 successful one-offs, pitch a monthly retainer. Typical Indian range: Rs. 30,000-3,00,000 per month depending on tier and deliverables. Offer 10-15 percent off one-off rates in exchange for the commitment.
- **Never fold extras into one inflated number.** Line items teach the brand what your work costs.

Do not convert US rate guides to rupees

US posts quote \$100-\$500 for micro creators; India's market pays Rs. 5,000-25,000 for the same tier. Quote from Indian benchmarks, not converted dollar figures - in both directions.

Three worked examples (real maths, real tiers)

Worked example 1 - Aarti, 3K followers, beauty niche, 5% engagement, starting with UGC. She has almost no audience to sell access to, so she sells content instead. Her rate card: UGC video without ad usage Rs. 2,000 (floor Rs. 1,500); UGC video with 90-day paid ad usage Rs. 4,000 (2x the no-usage rate); set of 3 Story frames mentioning the brand Rs. 600. Her realistic first month: 4 UGC deals from 40 pitches = Rs. 8,000-12,000, with zero dependence on follower count.

Worked example 2 - Rahul, 35K followers, personal finance in English + Hindi, 6% engagement. Base Reel rate: $35,000 / 10,000 \times \text{Rs. } 1,000 = \text{Rs. } 3,500$. Finance niche multiplier 1.5-2x and above-benchmark engagement take him to Rs. 7,000-10,000 per organic Reel; a campaign package (1 Reel + 3 Stories + 1 post) prices at Rs. 12,000-16,000; adding 90-day paid ad usage takes a package to Rs. 18,000-24,000. Two packages a month plus a UGC deal is a Rs. 35,000-45,000 month - a realistic micro-creator income in this niche.

Worked example 3 - Meera, 150K followers, food and cooking, 2.5% engagement. Base: $150,000 / 10,000 \times \text{Rs. } 1,000 = \text{Rs. } 15,000$, but food multiplies at 0.8-1.0x and engagement below 3% pulls the band down - so Rs. 12,000-15,000 per Reel is honest, not Rs. 25,000. Her fastest path to more money is not a bigger follower number but saves-driven Reels (recipe content that gets saved heavily) and her first retainer conversation with the two brands she already works with. Ambition is fine; quoting above your evidence invites brands to counter with data, and she loses that argument.

CHAPTER 4

Build your rate card (fill-in worksheet)

Brands expect a number within 24 hours of a conversation starting. Creators who reply "I'm flexible, what's your budget?" get an uncomfortably low opening offer, because they have signalled they do not know what they are worth. Fill this in once and you never freeze mid-negotiation again.

Step 1 - Your base numbers

Line	Fill in	How
Followers	_____	Instagram Insights, not your profile guess
Engagement rate	_____	Average of last 5 posts: (likes+comments+saves+shares) / followers x 100
Base Reel rate	_____	Followers / 10,000 x Rs. 1,000
Niche multiplier	_____	From Table 3, Chapter 3
Adjusted Reel rate	_____	Base x multiplier, then adjust for engagement

Step 2 - Your deliverable rates

Deliverable	Your rate	Guideline
Instagram Story (set of 3-5)	_____	30-50% of your Reel rate
Instagram Reel (organic use)	_____	Your adjusted Reel rate from Step 1
UGC video, no ad usage	_____	Floor Rs. 1,500; use Table 2, Chapter 3
UGC video + paid ad usage	_____	Minimum 2x the no-usage rate (Rs. 3,000+)
Feed carousel post	_____	Roughly 70-100% of your Reel rate
Campaign package (1 Reel + 3 Stories + 1 post)	_____	1.5-1.8x your Reel rate
Monthly retainer	_____	4-8 deliverables, 10-15% off one-off total

Step 3 - Presentation rules that hold your price

- Present rates as a clean 2-3 page PDF: your name and handle, platforms, key metrics, then a clear rate table by format with package options. Brands should never have to do maths to know what a Reel plus Stories costs.
- Name a range, not a single number: "For a branded Reel with story mentions I typically work in the Rs. X-Y range depending on usage rights and exclusivity."
- Add one line stating usage rights, exclusivity and rush delivery are available at additional rates. This alone prevents the most common scope trap in creator deals.
- Never send the rate card cold with your first pitch - confirm the brand's needs first, then attach it. The exception: if a brand asks, send it within 24 hours.

CHAPTER 5

The media kit that gets replies

When a brand manager shortlists ten creators, the ones who respond within 24 hours with a clean media kit and a clear rate card move forward. The kit is a 2-4 page PDF a brand can scan in under a minute. Here is exactly what goes on each page.

Page	Contents
Page 1 - You	Name and handles, platforms with follower counts, your niche in one clear sentence, engagement rate per platform, one line on why brands work with you
Page 2 - Your audience	Age ranges, gender split, top cities, top languages - pull straight from Instagram Insights. Urban 25-45 audiences command premium rates; say so if yours is one
Page 3 - Your work	2-3 best content pieces as images, past brand collaborations with results where you have them (reach, clicks, saves), any testimonials
Page 4 - Rates and contact	Your rate table by format and package, contact details, link-in-bio or website

If you have zero brand work, build page 3 from your best organic content with its real numbers - your top Reel's reach and saves are your proof of work. Keep every number honest: inflated stats end relationships fast, and brand managers check.

The fill-in opener for page 1:

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 1 - MEDIA KIT OPENING

When to use: Replace every bracket and keep it to one paragraph on page 1 of your kit.

I'm [Name], a [niche] creator on Instagram with [X]K followers and a [Y]% engagement rate. My audience is primarily [age range], [gender skew], based in [top cities], which aligns closely with brands selling [product category] to Indian buyers.

Build the kit in Canva (free templates work) and export as PDF. Update the stats monthly - a kit with last quarter's numbers quietly costs you deals.

Your first 48 hours after a brand replies

- Within 2 hours: acknowledge the message warmly, and ask for the brief with Script 7 - deliverables, timeline, usage rights, exclusivity.
- Within 24 hours: once the brief lands, send your rate card or a custom package quote based on it. Speed is the credibility signal - the first competent creator to quote usually sets the anchor.
- Within 48 hours: agree terms in writing with Script 12 and send the advance invoice. Do not shoot, edit or post anything before this lands.
- After delivery: send a short results note (reach, saves, link clicks) within a week. It sets up the retainer conversation (Script 11) better than any pitch ever will.

CHAPTER 6

Where the deals are

You do not have to wait for brands to find you. Inbound beats nothing, but the creators earning consistently run outbound alongside it. Five channels, in order of ease:

- 1 **Instagram Creator Marketplace** - Meta's built-in platform, free, no minimum follower requirement. Join from a professional account: Settings, then Creator, then Creator Marketplace. Fill in your niche, content categories and audience data, and brands can discover and message you in a dedicated Partnership Messages folder.
- 2 **Indian creator platforms** - list yourself on One Impression, Winkl (strong for micro-influencer D2C campaigns), Plixo (lifestyle, beauty, fashion) and Influencer.in. Complete profiles with accurate stats; brands filter by niche, city and engagement.
- 3 **Brands already paying creators** - search your niche's hashtags (#IndianSkincare, #MadeInIndia, #IndianDTC) and look for posts carrying the "Paid partnership with" label. Those brands have budget and a process. Also watch which brands sponsor creators slightly bigger than you - they usually scale down to micro creators next.
- 4 **Brands that follow you** - the accounts already in your DMs and follower list know your content. Even the one offering "free product for a post" usually has a budget if you ask (Script 10).
- 5 **Direct outreach** - find the marketing or partnerships lead on LinkedIn (search the brand name plus "Brand Manager" or "Partnerships"), and send the email scripts in Chapter 7. Cold reply rates run 1-5 percent, so this is a volume game - the maths works out in Chapter 8.

Your 30-brand prospect list

Open a spreadsheet. List 30 brands whose products genuinely fit your niche and that you would actually use. For each: Instagram handle, the paid-partnership evidence you found, the right contact person, and their last campaign. Prioritise small and mid-size Indian D2C brands already running creator content - they have budget, decide fast, and hire micro creators. This list is the fuel for every script in the next chapter.

Track every pitch (the tracker that makes the volume maths visible)

Copy these columns into your spreadsheet - the tracker is what turns outreach from mood into a system:

Brand	Contact	Sent	Follow-up 1 (day 5-7)	Follow-up 2 (day 12-15)	Stage	Next action
[Brand]	[name / handle]	[date]	[date / sent]	[date / sent]	Replied / Quoted / Won / Lost	[what and when]

One row per pitch, updated the day anything happens. Ten minutes a week on this sheet is the difference between "nothing is working" and knowing you are at 8 pitches and 2 replies - exactly on the expected 1-5 percent curve.

CHAPTER 7

The 12 copy-paste pitch scripts

Every bracket [like this] is yours to fill. Personalise the first line always - a pitch about the brand, not about you, is the one that gets answered. Keep DMs under 100 words and emails to 5-7 sentences, and never attach files in a first email.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 2 - THE UGC OPENER (DM or email)

When to use: First contact with a brand for UGC work. Zero followers needed - your samples do the selling.

Hi [Brand Name] team - I create short UGC videos for [skincare / fitness / your niche] brands in India. I noticed your [product / campaign]. I can film a 30-second talking-head or demo Reel you can use in ads and organic posts. Here are two samples in your niche: [link 1] [link 2]. Open to a quick chat this week?

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 3 - THE INFLUENCER PITCH (email)

When to use: First email to a brand manager you found on LinkedIn. Attach the media kit; send the rate card on request.

Subject: Instagram Reel Collaboration - [Your Handle] x [Brand Name]

Hi [Name], I'm [Your Name], a [category] creator on Instagram with [X]K followers and a [Y]% engagement rate. My audience is primarily [age range] based in [cities], which aligns closely with [Brand]'s [specific product or campaign]. I've worked with brands including [brand 1] and [brand 2], where my content reached [X] accounts.

I'd love to explore a Reel collaboration for [Brand]'s [product] in [month]. My media kit is attached; happy to share my rate card. Would you be open to a short call this week?

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 4 - THE 3-IDEAS PITCH

When to use: When you want to stand out in a crowded inbox - specific creative ideas beat credentials.

Subject: 3 Reel ideas for [Brand] x [Your name]

Hi [Name], I'm [Your Name], a [niche] creator in [city] with [X]K engaged followers. I love [specific product] because [one honest reason]. Here are 3 Reel concepts I'd shoot for your [launch / range]:

1. [idea 1 - problem-hook opening]
2. [idea 2 - demo format]
3. [idea 3 - trend or testimonial angle]

Media kit attached with rates. Open to a quick call this week?

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 5 - THE FIRST FOLLOW-UP (day 5-7)

When to use: Five to seven days after your first pitch. One follow-up is professional; five is spam.

Hi [Name], just floating this back up in case it got buried. The [specific idea] angle is timely for [reason - festival, season, launch], so happy to lock dates this week if it's a fit. Either way, would love to know what resonated.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 6 - THE FINAL FOLLOW-UP (day 12-15)

When to use: Twelve to fifteen days after the first pitch. Close the loop and stay on their radar for the next campaign.

Hi [Name], last note from me on this one - I'll assume timing isn't right and leave you to it. If [campaign type] comes back around, I'd love to be considered. Here's my latest Reel in case it's useful: [link].

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 7 - "WHAT ARE YOUR RATES?"

When to use: Any brand that asks your rates before sharing a brief. Never quote blind - scope changes the price.

Thanks for reaching out! Happy to explore the collaboration. Could you share the campaign brief - deliverables, timeline, usage rights and exclusivity requirements? Once I have those, I'll send the most suitable package and rate.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 8 - THE BUDGET-GAP COUNTER

When to use: When their budget is below your rate. Adjust the scope, never just the price.

Thanks for sharing your budget. At Rs. [X], here's what I can offer: [adjusted scope - e.g. 1 Reel with organic usage, stories removed, 45-day usage]. If you need the full original scope, the rate remains Rs. [Y]. Happy to work within whichever fits the campaign.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 9 - THE VALUE DEFENSE

When to use: When a brand says other creators charge less. Do not apologise for your rate; offer less scope.

I understand you may have received lower quotes. My rate reflects my [X]% engagement rate, my audience quality in [demographic], and my production standards - and I'm happy to discuss how we measure whether the content delivered. If it helps, I can offer a smaller starting engagement: [single Reel / one-month trial] instead of reducing the rate.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 10 - THE BARTER COUNTER

When to use: When a brand offers free product only. Many brands asking for barter do have budget - they just hoped you wouldn't ask.

Thanks for the offer! I'm past barter-only collaborations now, but I'd genuinely love to work with [Brand]. For this campaign I'd need a paid engagement - my rate for [deliverable] is Rs. [X]. If there's budget for creator content this quarter, I'm happy to be considered.

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 11 - THE RETAINER PITCH

When to use: After 2-3 successful one-off collaborations with the same brand. Retainers are how creators stabilise income.

Hi [Name], the [campaign] performed well, so I'd love to propose something ongoing. A monthly partnership - [2 Reels + 4 Stories + analytics report] at Rs. [X]/month - would keep the momentum consistent and cost about 10-15% less than booking each piece separately. Could I send a simple quarterly plan?

COPY-PASTE SCRIPT 12 - THE DEAL-CONFIRMATION EMAIL

When to use: Within hours of any verbal or DM agreement. This single email prevents the disputes that leave creators unpaid.

Hi [Name], confirming what we agreed so we're fully aligned:

- Deliverables: [e.g. 1 x 30-second Reel, posted on @handle, draft for approval by [date]]
 - Fee: Rs. [X], [50% advance / full amount] on [date], via [bank transfer]
 - Usage rights: [organic use only on brand's own social / paid ads for [90 days]]
 - Exclusivity: [none / no competing [category] brands for [30 days]]
 - Revisions: [1 round included]
 - Disclosure: I'll use Instagram's Paid Partnership label as required by ASCI guidelines
- Please reply with a confirmation and I'll send the advance invoice today.

CHAPTER 8**Negotiation: get paid what you're worth**

Negotiation is where Indian creators lose the most money - usually to themselves, before the brand even pushes back. These are the rules that stop that.

- **Know your floor before you open.** Your floor is the minimum you will accept for a deliverable given the time it takes. For a 30-second UGC talking-head with no ad usage, many Indian beginners set a floor of Rs. 1,500; with full ad usage rights, Rs. 3,000 or higher.
- **Quote 20-30 percent above your minimum.** Your opening number is a negotiation position, and most brands expect to negotiate.
- **Never reduce your rate before the brand pushes back.** The discount you offer in anticipation of a fight that never comes is pure loss. Send the rate, then wait.
- **Negotiate deliverables, not price.** Lower budget means fewer Stories, shorter usage, or a longer deadline - not a cheaper Reel.
- **Ask for their budget first when the gap feels big.** "What's the budget for this campaign?" is information gathering, not weakness - knowing their number lets you adjust scope precisely.
- **Let engagement data argue for you.** Your screenshots of reach, saves and past results are worth more than any adjective.

The ten questions to ask before quoting any deal

- 1 What content format does the brand need?
- 2 How many deliverables?
- 3 What is the posting deadline?
- 4 Will revisions be required, and how many rounds?
- 5 Where will the content be used - brand's own social only, or paid ads?
- 6 Is paid advertising (whitelisting/boosting) included?
- 7 Is exclusivity required, and for how long?
- 8 What are the payment terms - advance, and how many days to pay?

9 Who owns the raw files after delivery?

10 Is there a kill fee if the campaign is cancelled after content is shot?

The volume maths that ends discouragement

Cold reply rates run 1-5 percent. Send 100 personalised pitches and expect roughly 5-10 replies and 1-3 closed deals - that is the system working, not failing. At a pace of 5-10 personalised pitches a week with follow-ups, most creators land a first paid deal within 2-4 weeks. Volume plus relevance converts; one perfect pitch sent once does not.

A negotiation walkthrough (watch the rules work)

A D2C skincare brand replies to Priya (28K followers, 4.5% engagement) with: "We love your content! What would a Reel cost?" Watch the moves:

Step	What happens
1. Brief first	Priya: "Thanks so much! Could you share the brief - deliverables, timeline, usage rights and exclusivity?" She never quotes blind.
2. The quote	Brief: 1 organic Reel, 30-day organic brand-page repost, no ads. Her maths: $28,000/10,000 \times \text{Rs. } 1,000 = \text{Rs. } 2,800$ base; beauty is baseline niche, engagement above benchmark; she quotes the package as "Reel + 2 Stories, Rs. 5,500-6,500" - a range, 20-30% above her Rs. 5,000 floor.
3. The pushback	Brand: "Our budget is Rs. 3,000." Priya does not drop the price - she adjusts scope: "At Rs. 3,000 I can do the Reel alone, without the Stories, organic usage only. The Reel + Stories package stays Rs. 5,500." (Script 8.)
4. The close	Brand takes the Reel + Stories at Rs. 5,000. Priya sends Script 12 the same day: 50% advance, balance in 7 days, ASCI-compliant Paid Partnership label, 1 revision round. Everyone knows exactly what was agreed.
What she avoided	Quoting Rs. 3,000 "to be safe" (a 40% self-discount), unlimited usage silently included, chasing payment for 60 days, and no revision limit - the four most common Indian creator losses, handled in four messages.

Notice what Priya never did: apologised for her rate, dropped price without cutting scope, or quoted before seeing the brief. Every move is in Scripts 7, 8 and 12 - the negotiation is just the scripts in sequence.

CHAPTER 9

Usage rights and exclusivity

The most expensive mistake in creator deals is silent on usage: you are paid for a post, and the brand assumes it can also run your face in paid ads forever. Those are two different products with two different prices.

Right the brand wants	What it means	What to charge
Organic social use	Brand reposts your content on its own accounts	Included in your base rate

Right the brand wants	What it means	What to charge
Paid ad usage	Your content (and often your face) runs as Instagram/Facebook/Google ads	+30-100% on your base rate; treat +50% as the floor for ads
Whitelisting / boosting	Brand advertises from your handle as if it were you	Premium over standard ad usage; quote case by case
Exclusivity	You cannot work with competing brands for a period	Paid additionally, scaled to the window (30/60/90 days)
Raw file ownership	Brand keeps the unedited footage and reuses it	Charged as a separate licence line

Two habits keep this clean: state usage scope explicitly in your rate card ("rates include organic use on brand channels; paid usage, exclusivity and rush delivery quoted separately"), and confirm usage in the deal-confirmation email - Script 12 - before you shoot anything. A brand that wants your face in its ads for the next two years is a brand that can afford to pay for it.

Script to use when usage comes up

"Happy to include paid usage. Since the content would run in ads, the rate for Reel plus 90-day paid digital usage is Rs. [X] - about a 50% premium on organic-only, which is standard. Want me to send both options so you can compare?"

CHAPTER 10

Get paid, stay paid

The number-one cause of creator payment problems in India is the informal deal: a DM, a vague scope, and "we'll pay after posting." Every rule below exists to make sure your work converts to money.

- **Get it in writing before you shoot.** A contract or even the deal-confirmation email (Script 12) with a WhatsApp "confirmed" reply counts. For anything above Rs. 5,000, insist on a signed agreement.
- **Take 50 percent upfront.** This is the Indian market standard for creator deals - it filters out non-serious brands and protects your cash flow.
- **Set payment terms explicitly.** Request payment within 7 days of delivery. 30-45 days is the realistic Indian corporate standard; anything beyond 60 days is a red flag.
- **Never deliver final files or post before the balance clears** when you have any doubt about the brand. Watermark drafts; hand over masters on final payment.
- **Use escrow where available.** Creator platforms that hold the brand's money until milestones approve remove the chase entirely - worth a slightly lower rate for your first few deals.
- **Invoice like a business.** Include GSTIN if you are registered, a due date, and itemised deliverables. Keep records of every deal - creator income is taxable, and clean books make tax season painless.

Walk-away red flags

- No written scope, only "we'll figure it out".
- Payment only "after the brand sees results".

- Unlimited usage rights bundled into a one-post fee.
- "Exposure" offered instead of money after your first few paid deals.
- Pressure to post before the advance clears.
- A brand that negotiates hardest on price at the start is usually the most demanding client once work begins - price that in.

If a payment goes late

Day 1 overdue: send a polite reminder with the invoice attached. Day 7: a firmer note referencing the agreed terms. Day 15: a formal demand stating the contractual due date, and pause all pending deliverables. Creators with written terms and payment records recover dramatically more often than those relying on goodwill - which is the entire reason this chapter exists.

Invoice like a business (line-item template)

Invoice within 24 hours of the agreed trigger, with every agreed item on its own line:

Line item	Amount
1 x Instagram Reel - @yourhandle, posted [date], per agreement dated [date]	Rs. 5,000
2 x Instagram Story frames with link sticker	Rs. 1,500
90-day paid digital usage licence	Rs. 2,500
Subtotal	Rs. 9,000
Less: 50% advance received [date]	-Rs. 4,500
Balance due [date - 7 days from delivery]	Rs. 4,500

Add your name, address, PAN and bank details (GSTIN and GST at 18 percent if you are registered - creator services attract 18% GST once your annual turnover crosses the registration threshold). Note the due date and payment method on every invoice, and keep copies of agreements with them. Clean records are also what makes tax season painless.

CHAPTER 11

The ASCI rules: disclosure done right

India's Advertising Standards Council of India (ASCI) requires every paid or bartered promotion to carry a clear disclosure label. These rules apply to creators with 1K followers as much as to those with 10M, and both the brand and the creator are responsible for compliance. Non-compliance brings notices to you and the brand, and repeated violations land creators on ASCI's non-compliant list - which brands check.

When you must disclose

Disclosure is required whenever there is a **material connection** between you and the brand - payment, free or discounted products (even unsolicited), barter, affiliate links or discount codes, family or employment relationships. You must disclose even if your opinion is genuinely unbiased, and even if the brand never asked you to post. If you bought the product yourself and just like it, no disclosure is needed.

The permitted labels

Use one or more of: Advertisement, Ad, Sponsored, Collaboration, Partnership, Employee, Free gift, the Paid Partnership tag on Instagram, Affiliate, or the Includes Paid Promotion tag on YouTube. The label must be in English or in the language of the advertisement. Made-up labels like #collab, #sp, #spon or #brandambassador do not comply.

Where the label goes

- Up front and prominent - placed so an average viewer cannot miss it. Not in your bio or About, not at the end of a caption, and not behind a "more" click.
- Never buried in a pile of hashtags.
- Instagram's Paid Partnership label does not replace your own label - use it in addition to a caption label.
- For Stories and other posts without captions: superimpose the label over the image or video itself.
- For live streams: announce it at the beginning and the end of the broadcast, and add a caption label if the post stays up.

How long a video label must stay on screen

Video length	Minimum on-screen label time
15 seconds or less	At least 3 seconds
Longer than 15 seconds, under 2 minutes	At least one-third of the video's length
2 minutes or longer	The entire duration of every section where the brand or its features are mentioned

Special rules for finance creators

If you promote financial products - stocks, crypto, credit, insurance, or any BFSI product - ASCI additionally requires you to display the qualifications and registrations that permit you to give such advice (for example, a SEBI registration number, or an IRDAI licence), superimposed prominently on the video or stated up front in text posts. Unqualified creators may only share generic information, not product advice. Check ASCI's addendum before your first finance promotion.

Where to read the full rules: ASCI's Guidelines for Influencer Advertising in Digital Media and its influencer FAQ are published at asci.social - and its disclosure tool walks any specific post through the rules in two minutes.

CHAPTER 12

Instagram's official tools you should be using

- **Professional account (free).** Switch from a personal account in Settings to unlock Insights - your reach, engagement and audience data are the raw material for your media kit and every rate negotiation.
- **The Paid Partnership label.** When creating a branded post, use the paid partnership option in advanced settings to tag the brand. It satisfies Instagram's branded content policy, gives the brand access to the post's performance data, and keeps you on the right side of ASCI (in addition to your caption label).

- **Creator Marketplace.** Meta's free in-app marketplace where brands discover and brief creators. Join from Settings, then Creator, then Creator Marketplace. No minimum follower requirement; brand messages arrive in a dedicated Partnership Messages folder with campaign requirements and rates shown in the app.
- **Insights on every sponsored post.** Screenshot reach, saves and profile visits after each collaboration - these become the "results" section of your media kit and the evidence in your next negotiation.
- **Trial Reels.** Test hooks on non-followers before you deliver a brand Reel - showing a brand you validated the hook is a legitimate premium service.

CHAPTER 13

The 30-day first-deal plan

Everything in this kit, sequenced. Budget 5-7 hours a week. Creators who follow a plan like this typically close a first paid deal in weeks 3-4.

Week	Focus	What you do
Week 1	Foundation	Switch to a professional account. Define your niche in one sentence. Create 3-5 portfolio pieces (UGC samples for products you own). Screenshot your Insights: followers, engagement rate, audience demographics.
Week 2	Assets	Fill the Chapter 4 worksheet and build your rate card PDF. Build your 2-4 page media kit (Chapter 5). Join Creator Marketplace and list yourself on 2-3 Indian platforms (Chapter 6).
Week 3	Outreach	Build the 30-brand prospect list. Send your first 5-10 personalised pitches using Scripts 2-4. Log every send, and follow up with Script 5 on day 5-7.
Week 4	Close	Second follow-ups (Script 6). Negotiate with Chapter 8 rules - ask the ten questions, quote above your floor, adjust scope not price. Confirm the deal in writing with Script 12, take 50% advance, disclose per Chapter 11, deliver, invoice.

Then repeat weeks 3-4 forever: 5-10 personalised pitches a week, follow-ups on schedule, results screenshotted after every deal, rates reviewed every quarter. That loop - not follower count - is the difference between creators who earn from Instagram and creators who post for free.

CHAPTER 14

The one-page cheat sheet

Print this page. This is the whole kit on one card.

Situation	Your move
Setting any rate	Rs. 1,000 per 10K followers per Reel, times your niche multiplier, plus 30-100% for paid ad usage
Brand asks your rates first	Ask for the brief (Script 7) - never quote blind

Situation	Your move
Budget is too low	Reduce the scope, not the price (Script 8)
They say others are cheaper	Value defense - scope down, rate stays (Script 9)
Barter-only offer	Ask for budget politely (Script 10) - many have it
Verbal yes	Send the deal-confirmation email within hours (Script 12)
Payment terms	50% upfront, balance in 7 days requested; treat 60+ days as a red flag
Any sponsored post	ASCI label up front + Paid Partnership tag; video labels: 3s / one-third / full-section rule
Weekly rhythm	5-10 personalised pitches, follow-ups on day 5-7 and 12-15, Insights screenshotted after every deal
After 2-3 deals with one brand	Pitch the monthly retainer (Script 11)

SOURCES & VERIFICATION

Everything verified September 2026

All rates, rules and platform facts in this kit were checked against current sources as of September 2026:

- ASCI - Guidelines for Influencer Advertising in Digital Media, the influencer FAQ and the ASCI disclosure tool (asci.online.in / asci.social).
- Instagram / Meta Help Center - Paid Partnership label usage and Creator Marketplace eligibility and setup.
- Indian creator-economy rate benchmarks 2026: Flontic (rate card and pitch guides), Fluxnote (Instagram brand deal rates India 2026), Zokera (sponsored post pricing India 2026), upstageX (brand deal step-by-step with escrow), UGC Content (UGC collaboration rates and DM templates India), Trendweave (Instagram monetisation India 2026).
- DemandSage via Creatorflow - brand preference for nano and micro creators under 100K followers (April 2026).

Rates are market bands drawn from these sources and move with demand, niche and season. Treat them as your floor, not your ceiling.

THE INSTAGRAM BRAND DEAL KIT - The Indian Creator Edition